

THE SOUTHERN BELLE'S SECRET

A Southern Gothic Mystery

Written by K. R. Tenney

NCCA Entertainment Inc.



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LOGLINE

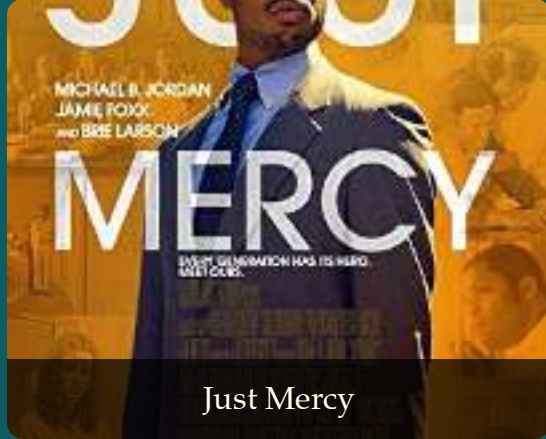


When an investigative journalist uncovers evidence linking her family to a decades-old lynching, a polished Atlanta socialite must choose between protecting her dynasty's legacy or exposing a truth that could destroy her world—and redeem her soul.

TONE & GENRE



Big Little Lies



Just Mercy



Sharp Objects



The Help

Genre:

Southern Gothic Mystery / Family Drama

Tone:

A blend of Big Little Lies prestige tension, Just Mercy justice arc, and Lifetime-style drama.

Format:

TV Movie-of-the-Week (Lifetime or streamers with similar MOW slates)

OUR HEROINE: CAROLINE BEAUMONT



25, a third-generation Southern belle raised in legacy and lies



Suffers from anxiety, performance fatigue, and repressed memories



Her arc: From fragile porcelain debutante to justice-seeking woman of integrity

"The pearls around my neck felt like a noose, choking me with the weight of everything I was supposed to be."

ELIAS THORNE



32, investigative reporter with personal stakes

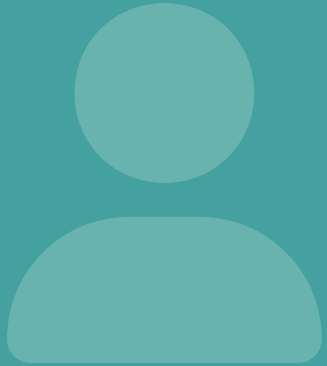
His grandfather was framed and executed for a murder tied to the Beaumont family

Torn between vengeance and unexpected empathy for Caroline

"The truth doesn't care about your family name."



ELEANOR & JUDGE CALDWELL



ELEANOR

The matriarch, ruthless and refined,
driven by a twisted idea of legacy.

ELEANOR



JUDGE CALDWELL

Caroline's father. A public servant
masking private corruption.

JUDGE
CALDWELL

"Behind every Southern dynasty lies a carefully curated facade."

THEMES & APPEAL



Magnolias



Pearls



Southern Legacy



Hidden Truths

Themes:

The Rot Beneath the Magnolias

Inherited Guilt vs. Moral Awakening

Truth as Fire: Destructive, Redemptive

Target Audience Appeal:



Perfect for Lifetime



Hallmark Mahogany

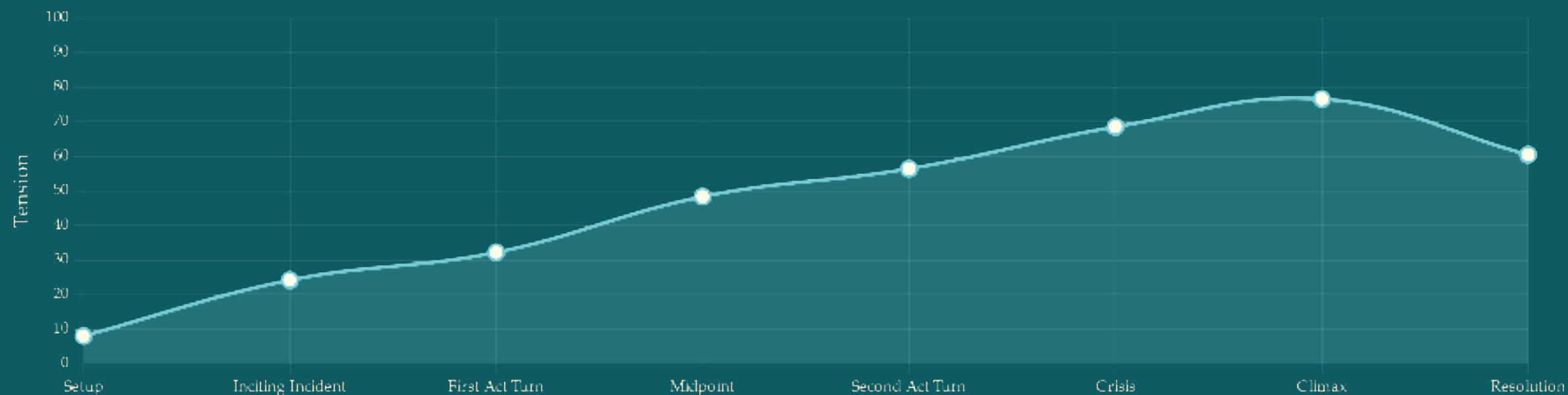


BET+



OWN

NARRATIVE STRUCTURE



Act I: The Facade Cracks

- Caroline's anxiety at family gala
- Elias confronts with evidence
- First flashbacks emerge
- Family pressure to maintain silence

Act II: Truth Emerges

- Caroline investigates family archives
- Alliance forms with Elias
- Eleanor's threats escalate
- Discovery of grandfather's role

Act III: The Reckoning

- Caroline confronts family legacy
- Public revelation of truth
- Judge Caldwell's confession
- Caroline's moral redemption

Final Image: Pearls broken, magnolia blooming

CASTING VISION (MOCK-UP)



Lili Reinhart

as Caroline Beaumont

Riverdale, Hustlers



Stephan James

as Elias Thorne

*If Beale Street Could Talk,
Homecoming*

We envision a prestige ensemble
with commercial appeal.

Diverse, layered, and audience-
friendly.



Susan Sarandon

as Eleanor

Feud, Thelma & Louise



Courtney B. Vance

as Judge Caldwell

*Lovecraft Country, The People v. O.J.
Simpson*

*"Casting that elevates the material
while maintaining accessibility."*

WHY NOW? WHY THIS?

**Wrongful Convictions in the South: New Evidence
Reopens Historical Cases** ²⁰²⁵

**Southern Identity Reimagined: Confronting the Past to
Heal the Present** ²⁰²⁵

The New Southern Belle: Tradition Meets Social Justice ²⁰²⁴

**Racial Reckoning in Southern Families: Hidden Histories
Come to Light** ²⁰²⁴



Offers catharsis through justice and truth



A fresh spin on the Southern Gothic with Black-led emotional stakes



Resonates with audiences seeking authentic representation and historical reconciliation

RESONATES WITH AUDIENCES OF:



Women of the Movement



Greenleaf



The Burial



Sharp Objects

NEXT STEPS

Available Materials

-  Script available (95–100 pages)
-  Moodboard, visual deck, and casting deck upon request
-  Production timeline flexibility
-  Open to co-production partnerships

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"Caroline stares at the broken strand of pearls in her palm. Each bead represents a lie she's been told. She looks up at the magnolia tree, its white blossoms stark against the stormy sky."

